QR Codes

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

A QR (Quick Response) code is a type of two-dimensional barcode. It's a machine-scannable image that a smartphone camera can read to link a physical item to a website or app.

QR codes create significant barriers if not implemented carefully. These barriers include:

- Users who are blind or have low vision cannot easily locate or scan a QR code
- A standard code provides no information about its destination before being scanned

How to support it

- Always include a short, readable uniform resource locator (URL) and a clear description of the link's purpose next to the code
- Use high-contrast colours (dark on light), a large size (at least 2.5 by 2.5 centimetres), and place it at a height reachable by all users

If you can avoid using a QR code, you should. Alternatives include short URLs, near-field communication (NFC) tags and Accessible QR (AQR) codes.

Useful Links

Accessibility and QR codes
What is an Accessible QR (AQR) code?
Making QR codes more accessible
Are QR Codes Accessible for People with Disabilities?
Accessible QR Codes – The Ultimate Guide